

WHERE TO FROM HERE

A number of years ago, I decided to face up to something that happened to me when I was a teenager. This was a tough, significant, traumatising thing and I didn't believe I had the resources to deal with it on my own. So, I booked in to see a very experienced therapist.

I remember the therapist asked in one of our very first sessions what I'd most like to achieve out of our time together. Quite rationally and calmly I explained that I was looking for the psychological equivalent of being able to pour bleach over my memories and erase them. I wanted to whitewash my story and to be able to do life without it weighing so heavily on me.

The therapist was very kind and suggested that even if she could do that (and it was potentially an option), the body stores memories and a lot of the physical symptoms I was experiencing were a direct result of both the trauma I had experienced and my body having stored its response to it. What we needed to do was listen to my body and to both quieten and reset how it was responding to everyday life. To find techniques, habits and more that would calm down its responses to situations where it was no longer threatened (which I didn't realise weren't normal). By the time I finished the many sessions I had with her, I had a toolkit of techniques I could employ—some of which I've mentioned in this book—that were a direct result of my own story. I'm incredibly grateful for them and continue to use them on a daily basis.

The reason I tell this story is because I can guarantee that most of you, when reading this book, have had insights into your own unconscious behaviour which you were unaware was the result of your Money Story,